



Recovering Deleted Files Easily

Here's a step-by-step guide to an application called PhotoRec, which helps you recover deleted data.

While most of us do regular back-ups of important data, some just postpone the back-up date until that dreaded day arrives—unexpectedly, in the blink of an eye, you suddenly realise all that precious data you gathered over months, has disappeared. Maybe it was just 'the wrong key' that got pressed. Well, it's time to start pulling your hair out and sweating profusely. May the Lord rescue you if your boss has a bad temper.

Well don't lose hope; there's PhotoRec to the rescue. A huge list of 140 different file types like JPEG, MID, SQLite, Real Audio, MP3, *.doc*, Macromedia, *.exe*, *.flv*, VMware images, *.chm*, *.bz2*, Autocad, RAR, Adobe Photoshop images, etc, are supported. This tutorial will help you in recovering your data without emptying your pockets—and hey, I hope it'll put the smile back on your face once you're out of

your dire straits. However, you will have to spend some time searching for *that* important file.

PhotoRec is an open source multi-platform application distributed under the GPL. It is a companion program to TestDisk, an application for the recovery of lost partitions for a variety of file systems and to make disks bootable again.

Apart from Linux, PhotoRec supports the following operating systems:

- DOS/Win9x
- Windows NT 4/2000/XP/2003/Vista
- FreeBSD, NetBSD, OpenBSD
- Sun Solaris
- Mac OS X
- UNIX

PhotoRec can recover lost files from the following file systems:

- FAT/FAT32
- NTFS
- EXT2/EXT3